

Normally money saved in a retirement account, such as an IRA, should be left there for that purpose. However, if no other source of funds is available, you can invade the retirement account and withdraw funds. Be aware that there will be income taxes due and a 10 percent penalty.

Borrowing from an employer-sponsored retirement plan, such as a 401(k), is possible under certain circumstances, but strict rules govern this action. Check with your company benefits department for information and guidelines.